

5. Make sure Back up is turned on.
6. Confirm the backup account is the one you actually want.

Then comes the part people skip: deciding what not to back up. Google Photos lets you choose Back up device folders from the same settings area, and you can turn individual folders on or off. This is crucial. Your Camera folder may deserve permanent backup. Your WhatsApp Images folder probably does not need to ingest every “Good Morning” flower JPEG your extended family has ever forwarded. Screenshot folders are another trap. Useful screenshots are great. Hundreds of temporary screenshots of OTPs, recipes, maps, shopping pages, and memes are not your legacy.

Device folders worth reviewing carefully

- **Camera:** usually yes
- **Screenshots:** maybe, but rarely all of them
- **WhatsApp Images/Videos:** only if truly needed
- **Downloads:** usually no
- **Telegram or social-media saves:** probably no
- **Scans or document folders:** often yes, if they contain important records

This single decision often determines whether your Google storage remains useful or gets eaten alive by junk.

Step 4: Set mobile-data rules before your plan punishes you

Google Photos gives Android users more control than many realize over how uploads behave on mobile data. Google’s support page says you can go to Photos settings > Backup > Mobile data

usage and set a daily limit for automatic photo/video backup over mobile data. It also says you can enable Backup while roaming, or choose Only use unrestricted mobile data when data will not count against your plan. Those are helpful controls, but they can also become self-sabotage if enabled carelessly.

For most Indian readers, the smart default is simple:

- let big backups happen on Wi-Fi
- keep mobile-data backup limited or off for videos
- avoid roaming backup unless you know exactly why you need it
- use unrestricted data only if your plan genuinely treats it as free

Do this now:

1. In Google Photos, go to Photos settings > Backup > Mobile data usage.
2. Set a reasonable daily limit or restrict large uploads to Wi-Fi.
3. Leave Backup while roaming off unless necessary.
4. Revisit this after travel or plan changes.

A backup that wrecks your mobile bill is technically functioning, but spiritually incorrect.

Step 5: Choose backup quality

Google Photos still provides a Backup quality setting, and Google’s help page says you can change it by going to Photos settings > Backup > Backup quality. It also notes a blunt but important reality: if you’re out of storage, you can’t change your backup quality. That means waiting until your account is full is exactly the wrong time to start thinking strategically.

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